Bodo Cultural Heritage: Phake-sol (Bodo Riddles)

Category: FOLKLORE | Region: Assam | Status: needs_check

Bibliographic Citation & Provenance:

Bodo Folk Literature & Oral Traditions (Bodo Sahitya Sabha)

Narrative & Cultural Documentation:

Phake-sol (also known as Solobatha or Batha Minu) are traditional intellect-testing folk riddles cherished in Bodo oral literature. Typically shared during family gatherings around evening hearths or community resting spots, they combine vivid observations of nature, domestic objects, flora, and fauna with poetic metaphor.

Key classic Bodo riddles include: 1. Needle and Thread (Thura aro Khun): "Ultha khalao, thaithw bwlai; gansayao thwi, daiflayao fwi" - Has an eye in its tail, pierces through fabric and leaves a colorful winding trail. 2. Bamboo and Shoot (Mewa aro Oa): "Gothoni bima dokhona gannw ronga, bima janayano dokhona garw" - Clothed in many layers as an infant, stands completely bare as an adult. 3. Egg (Daodwi): "Darw gaya, jendwi gaya; bikhasinao mwdwi do" - A smooth white stone palace with neither door nor window, holding liquid gold and silver within. 4. Smoke (Ukhundwi): "Begen gaya, athing gaya; okhaonao barlangw" - Born boneless, rising into the sky without legs, dissolved by the passing breeze. 5. Spider (Gonggang): "Khorw gaya, athing zeng zeng; noh luyw baorw gaya" - Eight sprawling legs, weaving an intricate circular palace suspended in mid-air without wood. 6. Pineapple (Anaras): "Gwswnao mukut, sayao mukut; sinao gothao, bikhayao susulwi" - Green serrated crown on its head, thorny armor on its body, sweet nectar inside. 7. Fire (Or): "Janaykhw hwywbla bango, dwi hwywbla thwiyw" - Grows larger when fed dry timber, perishes when offered a sip of water. 8. Paddy Sheaf (Mai): "Gothw smao ganse gannwi, bima smao gonso gonso" - Stands tall and erect in youthful green; bows its head humbly to the earth in golden maturity.